ENG HUB

Storyline Spin

Students are given a brief outline of a story or scene. They then have to expand it by adding dialogue, character thoughts, or descriptions. This can be done individually or in groups, and encourages detailed and imaginative use of language.

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Instructions

- Split the class into small groups or pairs, either in person or in breakout rooms if online.
- Hand out or digitally assign one story outline to each group/pair.
- Tell students to expand their outline into a full scene with dialogue, character thoughts, and descriptions.
- Allocate 10-15 minutes for story development and 5 minutes for sharing.
- Offer guidance on character and plot development, and encourage the use of diverse vocabulary.
- Have groups present their stories to the class, or swap stories between groups for feedback.
- Provide feedback focusing on language use, creativity, and narrative development.

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EXPAND THE GIVEN STORY OUTLINE INTO A DETAILED AND IMAGINATIVE SCENE OR NARRATIVE, INCORPORATING DIALOGUE, CHARACTER THOUGHTS, AND VIVID DESCRIPTIONS.

A man rushes to catch the last train of the night, only to find himself in a carriage with an intriguing stranger.

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EXPAND THE GIVEN STORY OUTLINE INTO A DETAILED AND IMAGINATIVE SCENE OR NARRATIVE, INCORPORATING DIALOGUE, CHARACTER THOUGHTS, AND VIVID DESCRIPTIONS.

A character receives an unexpected package with no return address. Inside is a strange, antique key.

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EXPAND THE GIVEN STORY OUTLINE INTO A DETAILED AND IMAGINATIVE SCENE OR NARRATIVE, INCORPORATING DIALOGUE, CHARACTER THOUGHTS, AND VIVID DESCRIPTIONS.

Two old friends bump into each other in an unlikely place after many years, revealing surprising changes in their lives.

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A character discovers a hidden door in their new apartment that leads to an unexpected place.

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A musician hears a haunting melody that they can't quite remember, leading them on a quest to uncover its origins.

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A character finds an old, unsent love letter while cleaning out their attic, stirring up past emotions.

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A character visits a diner at midnight and meets a group of unusual people, each with a unique story.

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A family heirloom* goes missing, and the search for it reveals long-hidden family secrets.

*A VALUABLE OBJECT THAT HAS BELONGED TO A FAMILY FOR SEVERAL GENERATIONS.

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A character finds an old photograph of their parents with a person they don't recognize, sparking a journey to discover the truth.

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A character hosts a dinner party, but an unexpected guest arrives, turning the evening into a mysterious affair.

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A character inherits an old clock that doesn't work, but strange things start happening when they try to fix it.

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A character finds a message in a bottle on the beach, leading them on an adventure to find the sender.

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A character goes stargazing and has a profound encounter that changes their perspective on life.

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A character discovers a diary from decades ago in a second-hand bookshop, revealing a compelling story.

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A character takes a walk in the woods and hears whispers, leading them to a mysterious discovery.

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